On 27 October, Army HQ ordered Delhi and East Punjab Command to despatch 50 (Independent) Parachute Brigade Group to Jammu by road while HQ 161 Infantry Brigade with associated elements was sent to Srinagar by air. Simultaneously, Army HQ asked all commands to make troops available for the Kashmir operation. By 31 October, 161 Infantry Brigade (1 SIKH, 1 PARA, elements of 4 KUMAON and 1 MAHAR plus 13 Bty RIA and administrative elements) was located at Srinagar while 3 PARA with a company of medium machine guns (1 MAHAR) was at Jammu.

As the reinforcements were coming into Srinagar both by air and by road, Brigadier J.C. Katoch extended 161 Infantry Brigade's defensive perimeter to include the city of Srinagar, and planned to advance west and drive the raiders out of the Kashmir Valley. Before the offensive could begin, however, 161 Infantry Brigade's defensive positions at Shalateng were attacked by massed Pakistani militias.

The battle started with Pakistani militias attacking the Indian defensive positions manned by 1 SIKH and 1 KUMAON, with one company of 4 KUMAON in reserve. Seriously outnumbered, 1 SIKH held back the attackers while elements of 7 CAVALRY manoeuvred to get into position behind the attackers, with 1 KUMAON making an advance on the enemy's right flank. Caught in a three-pronged pincer, the raiders withdrew, leaving behind 700 dead and most of their equipment and ammunition. The Indian troops recaptured Baramulla the next day and Uri on 13 November. With this, all Pakistani forces were forced out of the Kashmir Valley.

The next Indian objective was to clear the Jammu region. The relief force from 50 (Independent) Parachute Brigade reached Kotli on 26 November, but was soon forced to evacuate the town. Similarly, the Indian Army relief force managed to fight its way into Poonch, but its siege was to continue for another year. Meanwhile, Mirpur fell to Pakistani troops on 25 November. There were other Pakistani successes in the north as Gilgit acceded to Pakistan while Skardu, the last garrison in the north, was surrounded by a Pakistani task force.

By the end of November, initial Indian operations had been completed. Army HQ continued to maintain troops and consolidate the position as far west as possible from Uri. Even as the Indian Army build-up continued, Pakistan struck first at Uri and then at Jhangar towards the end of December